

Ring Tile

Ring Tile is a tile game designed in 2016 by Agshin Jafarov to combine depth, elegance, and minimalism in a game. It has two variants, Minor Ring Tile and Major Ring Tile. The minor one is basis for the major one, so this document first describes rules of Minor Ring Tile and after that, Major Ring Tile.

Minor Ring Tile

Equipment

Enough quantity (60-70) of identical square tiles whose one side is black, and the other side is white.

Goal

Make a territory with your tiles by surrounding an open area from all four sides with self-connecting line.

Territory may or may not be partially filled with opponent's tile(s) and its corners may or may not be occupied by friendly tiles. Capturing opponent's tile (explained later) leads to forming such a territory as well.

Territories come in all shapes and sizes, but the smallest one takes just 4 (four) tiles to build. Whoever makes first territory of whatever size or shape (before your opponent) wins the game.

Play Rules

Players take turns. Black moves first and places a tile on any flat surface (no board) and black side up. Then White moves and places second tile white side up touching either corner-to-corner or edge-to-edge (or both) to another tile. An edge of the newly placed tile must be unoccupied by opponent's tile (or it may not be placed in a position where all four edges would be occupied by opponent's tiles). After that play alternates.

Tile placement is legal if newly placed tile shows just-moved player's color, touches another tile, and if an edge of the tile is unoccupied by opponent's tile which would disconnect it from open area. A tile's connection to open area can either be direct (one edge is literally unoccupied) or indirect (the tile touches edge-to-edge to another friendly tile or group of them that has direct connection to open area).

Capture

If you play edge-to-edge to all edges of opponent's tile (or a group) you capture that tile by removing it from the tile field and win the game. For capture the newly placed capturing tile must always have an edge unoccupied by unfriendly tile (before, during, and after the

capture). In other words, player may not play a tile into an illegal area in the hopes of capturing and opening an unoccupied edge for the capturing tile.

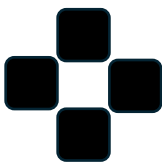
First player to make a territory (by surrounding an open area and/or by capture) with his tiles wins the game.

Pictures And Examples for Minor Loop Tile

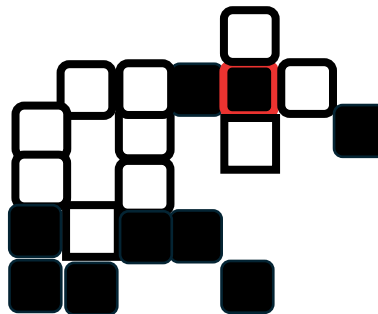
Simplest and smallest shape of a territory (black in diag. 1) takes just four tiles to build. Diagram 2 shows white territory with other tiles attached and three of its corners occupied.

Notice that although red-outlined black tile has no unoccupied edge (or no direct connection with open area via unoccupied edge), it is connected edge-to-edge to another friendly tile that has two open edges unoccupied by white tiles. Thus, red-outlined tile is connected to open area indirectly.

D1. Smallest black loop



D.2. Larger white loop attached to a group of tiles



Major Ring Tile

All the rules of Minor Ring Tile apply but the goal is expanded. There are two ways to win major ring tile game.

A) By making a ring which is a subset of territories that surround an open area from all four sides *plus from all corners*. Ring is a kind of complete territory whose all corners (and not just all sides) are occupied by friendly tiles. They come in all shapes and sizes, but the smallest one takes 8 (eight) tiles to build. First one to make a ring wins the game.

B) By making territories (or a territory) which are loop shapes with a corner unoccupied by a friendly tile. Territory is a kind of incomplete ring because at least one corner of it is either empty or occupied by an unfriendly tile. To win the game, total size of all territories

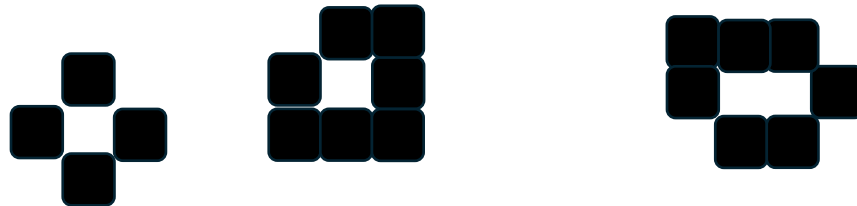
(or a single large territory) must be equal to 8 (eight) tiles, the number of tiles required to build a ring.

The area or size of a territory in Major Ring Tile is measured by how many tiles would fit into the empty area surrounded by that territory. The smallest territory can be filled with only one tile and thus it is worth one tile. If a territory is partially filled with opponent's tiles, then the occupied area of that territory is not counted towards victory unless opposing tiles are captured. Capturing a tile (or a group of tiles) in major loop tile game does not automatically win unless it creates large enough open area (individually or together with other territories).

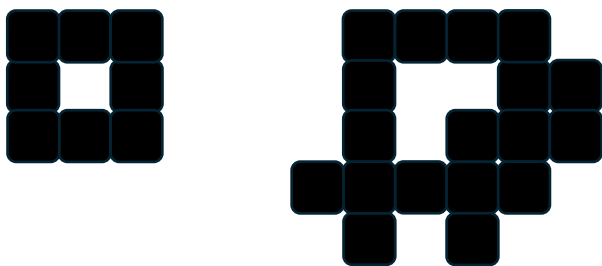
Pictures And Examples for Major Ring Tile

In major ring tile it is easier and faster to make a territory than a ring. Black territories worth of one point and two points: none of these shapes win the game unlike in minor ring tile.

Black territories in major ring tile



Black Rings (that wins the game)



Ring Tile game can be played on go boards and with go stones. Below is an example of a finished Major Ring tile game I played on go board (the picture doesn't show the Go board, but the board defined how far and in what directions game can grow). Black won

this game by making a territory (highlighted in yellow-framed tiles) as large as worth of 10 (ten) tiles, instead of a loop. Notice that this count doesn't include blue's territory (highlighted with dashed-line framed tiles) worth of 1 (one) tile located inside black's territory.

